

Graduate Student / Supervisor Expectations

The document is for students and their supervisors. Ideally, supervisors and students will discuss the document, retain copies of the document, and have a copy of the document placed in a student's file. Discussion of expectations can foster open communication between **supervisors and students and prevent misunderstandings that might otherwise arise.**

This document is not a replacement for University rules. To the extent that any statements in this document contradict Simon Fraser University policies, rules, or regulations, the Simon Fraser University policies, rules and regulations prevail. Ultimately, successful completion of a graduate program of study is the student's responsibility.

Mutual understanding of expectations between students and their supervisors is critical to the success of a graduate program. This document is intended to be read and discussed by students and their supervisors at the onset of the students' programs. This document may be re-visited and modified over time as necessary, with any revised versions held by students and supervisors and kept on students' files. Students undertaking work at the master's level will find some of the points outlined are specific to doctoral students.

Name of Supervisor and Date: Ailene MacPherson

As your supervisor, you can expect me to:

- Demonstrate commitment to your research and educational program, and offer stimulation, respectful support, constructive criticism, and consistent encouragement.
- Assist with identification of a research topic that is suitable for you and manageable within the scope of your degree.
- Discuss your financial support issues and assist with scholarship applications and/or providing advice on academic employment opportunities.
- Provide guidance in the ethical conduct of research and model research integrity.
- Discuss with you the implications of engaging with activities/work unrelated to your thesis topic.
- Provide information about my availability for meetings and expectations about preparation for meetings.
- Assist you in planning your research program, setting a time frame, and adhering as much as possible to the schedule.
- Encourage you to finish up when it would not be in your best interest to stay longer.
- Be accessible for consultation and discussion of your academic progress and research. On average, our meetings will be held weekly.
- Minimize my expectations for activities/work that may interfere with your thesis completion.
- Institute a supervisory committee (with appropriate input from you) and prepare for committee meetings, which will occur on a regular basis (at least once a year) to review your progress and provide guidance for your future work.
- Support you in your preparation of your thesis and examinations related to your thesis.
- Submit recommendations for examiners.
- Acknowledge your contributions, when appropriate, in published material and oral presentations in accordance with good scholarly practice.
- Provide reasonable expectations about work schedules and vacation time in accordance with Simon Fraser University policies.
- Clarify my preferred style of communication with students about areas, such as student independence, approaches to conflict, direct questioning, and mentoring.

- Explain my expectations for professional behaviour (e.g. punctuality, communication), when to seek assistance, response to constructive criticism, and academic performance expectations.
- Assist you to overcome any cultural difficulties with norms and expectations.
- Respond thoroughly (with constructive suggestions for improvement) and in a timely fashion to submitted, written work.
- Promote a research environment that is safe and free from harassment.
- Assist in managing conflict or differences among members of the supervisory committee.
- Make arrangements to ensure adequate supervision if I am absent for extended periods, e.g. more than a month.
- Encourage you to present your research results within and outside the University.
- Provide mentoring in academic writing.
- Provide advice and mentorship with respect to career opportunities, which may be assisted by resources, skills, professional development, and other avenues.

supervisor signature

supervisor print name

date

Name of Student and Date: _____

As your student, you can expect me to:

- Take responsibility for my progress towards my degree completion.
- Demonstrate commitment and dedicated effort in gaining the necessary background knowledge and skills to carry out the thesis.
- Take ownership of my research project(s), while following your advice and direction.
- Complete requested tasks and respond to communications in a timely manner.
- At all times, demonstrate research integrity and conduct research in an ethical manner in accordance with Simon Fraser University policies and the policies or other requirements of any organizations funding my research.
- Discuss any of my use of AI tools with you, and use them judiciously and in accordance with Simon Fraser University policies and the policies or other requirements of any organizations funding my research.
- In conjunction with you, develop a plan and a timetable for completion of each stage of the thesis project.
- Take responsibility for my financial relationship with the University, including paying necessary fees to the University.
- As applicable, apply to the University or granting agencies for financial awards or other necessary resources for the research.
- Discuss Teaching Assistant positions with you and apply for them on time.
- Meet standards and deadlines of the funding organization for a scholarship or grant.
- Adhere to negotiated schedules and meet appropriate deadlines.
- Keep you and Graduate Studies informed about my contact information.
- Meet and correspond with you when requested within specified time frames.
- Report fully and regularly on my progress and results.
- Maintain my registration and ensure any required permits or authorizations are kept up to date until the program is completed.
- Be thoughtful and reasonably frugal in using resources.
- Behave in a respectful manner with peers and colleagues
- Conform to the University and departmental/faculty requirements for my program.
- Meet at regular intervals and at least every year with my supervisory committee.
- Prepare for supervisor/committee meetings and make appropriate notes during meetings.
- Prepare for, attend, and contribute to the monthly MAGPIE meetings (when possible).
- Progress to milestones towards my thesis defense (including completion of comprehensive exam and proposal, for PhD students) within the stated timelines of my program.
- Keep orderly records of my research activities.
- Develop a clear understanding concerning ownership of intellectual property and scholarly integrity.
- Take any required training programs that are discussed and agreed.
- Work at least regular workday hours on my research project after course-work has been completed.
- Discuss, with you, the policy on use of computers and equipment.
- Complete my thesis and course work within timelines specified by my program.
- Finish my work and clear up my work space when program requirements have been completed.
- Return any borrowed materials on project completion or when requested.

- Explain to you my comfort with modes of communication (e.g. formal or informal, use of questioning) and independent activities.
- Make it clear to you when I do not understand what is expected of me.
- Describe my comfort with approaches to our academic relationship, e.g. professional versus personal.
- Contribute to a safe workplace where each individual shows tolerance and respect for the rights of others.
- Respond respectfully to advice and criticisms (indicating acceptance or rationale for rejection) received from you and members of my supervisory committee.
- Inform you in a timely manner about any of my presentations to facilitate attendance.
- Inform you of any planned vacation time.
- Give at least two weeks' notice for references or other materials required from you.
- Discuss, with you, my career plan and hopes for professional growth and development.
- Inform you in a timely manner if there are circumstances that may negatively affect my progress towards my degree completion.
- Adhere to the Group Ethos statement: <https://ecoevotheory.com/ethos/>
- Work towards publication of research results, in consultation with you.

student signature

student print name

date